



Bruce Banner shares the Leader's final moments in the physical world and witnesses his ascension to a new plane of existence.

LEADER

After dropping out of school, Samuel Sterns took a menial job in a US government research facility, where an accident led to his body being bombarded by intense gamma radiation. In the days that followed, Sterns developed an insatiable thirst for knowledge, and as his intelligence expanded at exponential rates, so too did his cranium.

Unfortunately, Sterns' increased intellectual capacity was not matched by emotional maturity. Disgusted by government corruption, he decided that he should command the human race, and restyled himself as the Leader.

Over the years, the Leader's efforts to dominate the world have been repeatedly foiled by the HULK and undermined by his own impatience. The Leader has battled that green behemoth with robotic humanoids and even pitted SuperVillains like the RHINO and the GLOB against him, but global domination has remained elusive. However, he has had some successes, in particular the construction of Freehold, a utopian city hidden in Canada's icy north.

After World War Hulk, the Leader teleported the at-large members of the Warbound to his base in Nevada. Once there, he used their powers to activate a Gamma-powered dome over the desert and irradiate everyone inside. The Warbound managed to stop him—for now. **AD, MF**



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Samuel Sterns

OCCUPATION

Would-be world conqueror

BASE

Another dimension

HEIGHT

5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT

140 lbs

EYES

Green

HAIR

Black

FIRST APPEARANCE

Tales to Astonish #62
(December 1964)

Superhuman intelligence, several times that of a genius, with an incredible memory for facts and information. Specializes in creating robots, computer systems, high-tech weapons. Has devised methods of telepathic control.

LEADER, THE

POWERS

LEECH

FIRST APPEARANCE Uncanny X-Men #179 (March 1984)

REAL NAME Unrevealed

OCCUPATION Adventurer **BASE** Various

HEIGHT 4 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 67 lbs **EYES** Yellow **HAIR** None

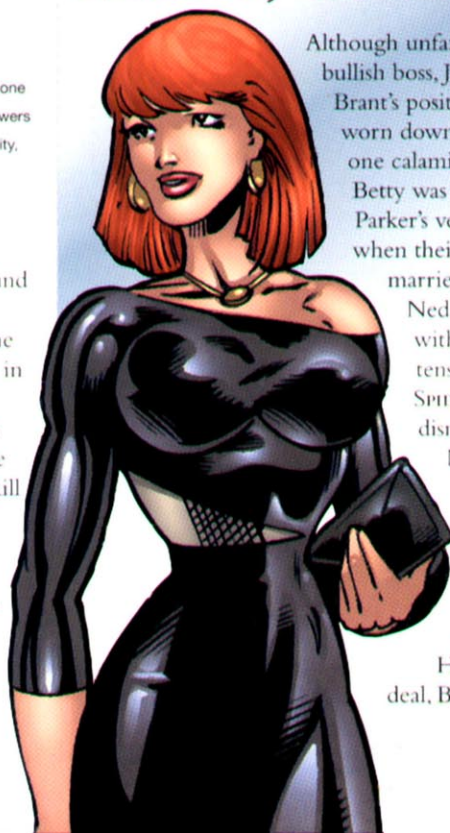
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Leech can dampen the superhuman powers of any Super Heroes or Villains, mutant or not, within his proximity, up to a range of 30 ft.



Abandoned by his parents, Leech was found by CALIBAN, who welcomed him into the MORLOCKS, who lived in the sewers beneath Manhattan. Leech was happy there—until the MARAUDERS came to kill

the Morlocks. POWER PACK and X-FACTOR saved him, and the green-skinned boy lived with X-FACTOR as one of the X-Terminators, and then worked with GENERATION X and the DAYDREAMERS. The WEAPON X program later captured Leech and used him to control mutant prisoners. He escaped and survived M-Day with his powers intact. **TB, MF**

LEEDS, BETTY BRANT



Although unfazed by the rantings of her bullish boss, J. Jonah JAMESON, Betty Brant's positive outlook was gradually worn down as events drove her from one calamity to another.

Betty was SPIDER-MAN Peter Parker's very first girlfriend, and when their relationship ended, she

married *Daily Bugle* reporter Ned Leeds. Ned's obsession with his work caused constant tension, which he blamed on SPIDER-MAN. She was dismayed to discover that

Ned had become the evil HOBGOBLIN, and suffered a mental breakdown following his death. Since then, Betty has rebuilt her life, becoming an investigative reporter. It was she who discovered that Roderick Kingsley was the original Hobgoblin. Having experienced the worst that life can deal, Betty can now look to the future with confidence. **AD**

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Betty Brant Leeds

OCCUPATION

Investigative journalist

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

5 ft 7 in

WEIGHT

125 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE:

Amazing Spider-Man #4
(September 1963)

Expert investigative reporter with a strong personality and a hugely generous soul.

LEEDS, BETTY BRANT

POWERS